Monday: Fundamentals & Footwork

Weeks 1-2: Sep 28, Oct 5 | RPE 6 | ~60 min

Standard warm-up

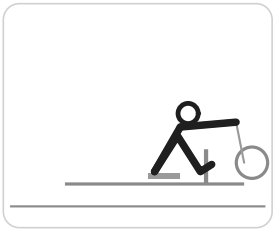
12-14 min

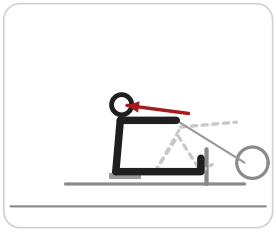
Rower stroke

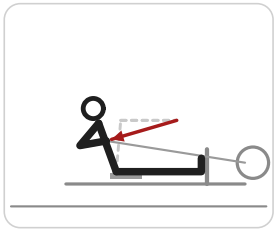
3 x 2 min, 30 sec rest: easy, moderate, a little brisker. 20-24 strokes/min, damper 3-5.

Side view

1. Catch: shins vertical, arms long, lean slightly forward.
2. Drive: legs first, then lean back, then pull to your lower ribs.
3. Recovery: arms, body, then legs. The reverse order.
4. Damper 3–5.


Catch


Legs drive

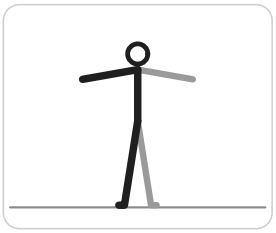

Finish

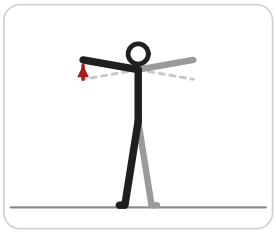
Arm circles

10 forward, 10 backward

Front view

1. Arms straight out at shoulder height.
2. Start with small circles, let them grow.
3. Reverse direction halfway.


Arms out

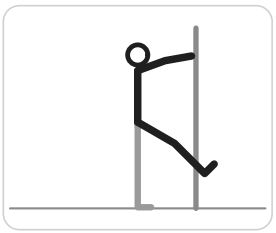

Circle

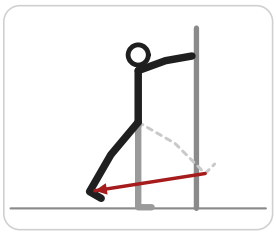
Leg swings

10 per leg

Side view

1. Hold a wall for balance.
2. Swing forward and back, loose and controlled.
3. Stay tall. Don't let your back round.


Swing forward

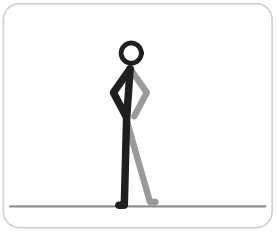

Swing back

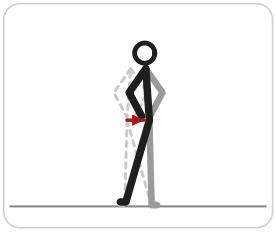
Hip circles

10 each direction

Front view

1. Hands on hips, feet shoulder-width apart.
2. Draw big, slow circles with your hips.
3. Keep your head and shoulders quiet.


Hips left

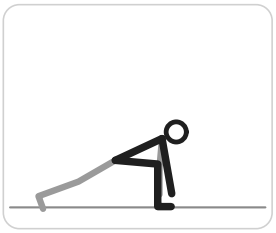

Hips right

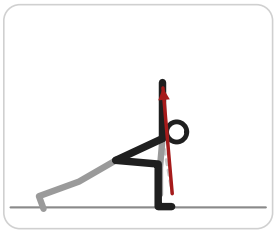
World's greatest stretch

3 per side

Side view

1. Step into a deep lunge, back knee off the floor.
2. Drop your inside elbow toward your front instep.
3. Rotate and reach that hand to the ceiling. Eyes follow the hand.


Elbow to instep

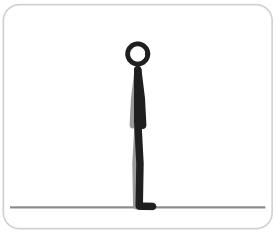

Rotate and reach

Bodyweight squat

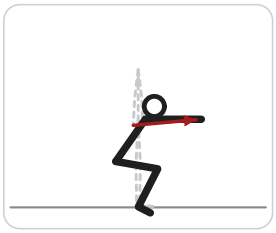
10 reps

Side view

1. Feet shoulder-width, toes slightly out.
2. Sit back and down, chest up, arms forward.
3. Knees track over toes. Drive up through the whole foot.



Stand tall



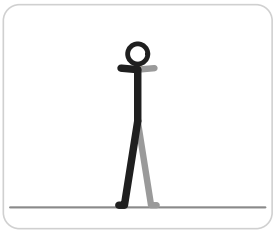
Bottom

Band pull-apart

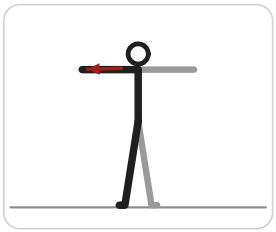
15 reps

Front view

1. Hold the band at chest height, arms straight in front.
2. Pull it apart until it touches your chest.
3. Squeeze your shoulder blades. Control the return.



Arms in front



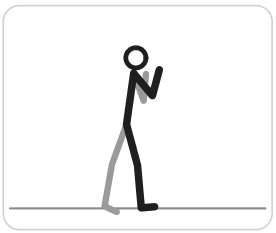
Pull apart

Stance bounce

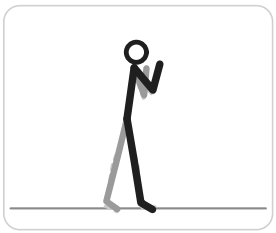
90 sec

Side view

1. Stay in your stance, hands up.
2. Small, light bounces on the balls of your feet.
3. Shift forward, back, and side to side without losing the stance shape.



Down



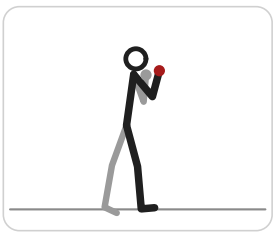
Up

The 1-2

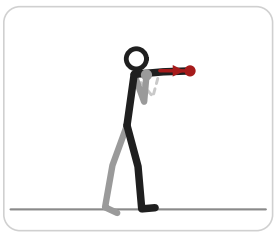
Shadowbox 2 x 2 min at 50%

Side view

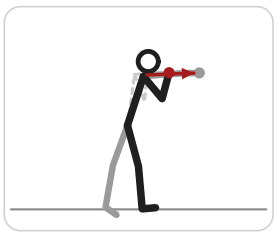
1. Jab, bring it back, then cross.
2. Breathe out sharply on each punch.
3. Step in with the jab. Step out after the cross.



Guard



1: Jab



2: Cross

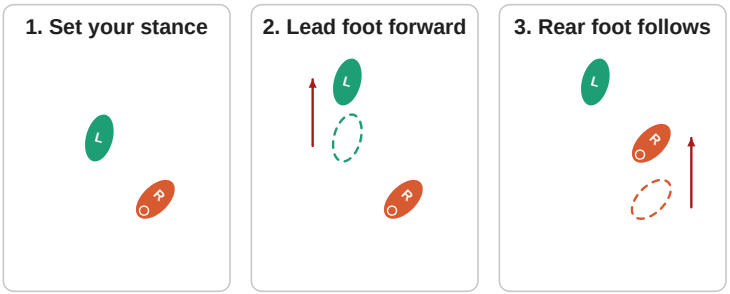
Footwork drills

12 min, in front of a mirror if you can

Footwork: Step forward

Step-drag, all four directions: 4 x 1 min, 30 sec rest

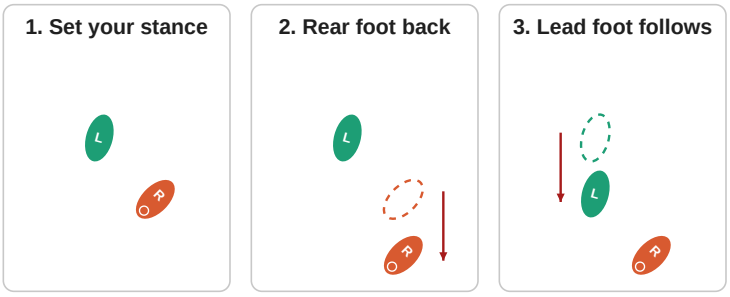
See the footwork sheet for full cues.



Dark limbs = near side Light limbs = far side Dashed gray = previous position Red arrow = what moves

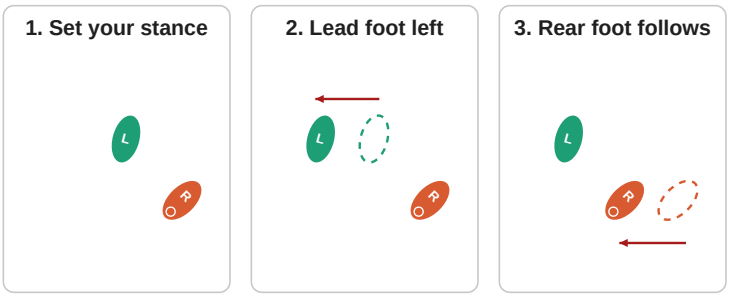
Footwork: Step back

See the footwork sheet for full cues.



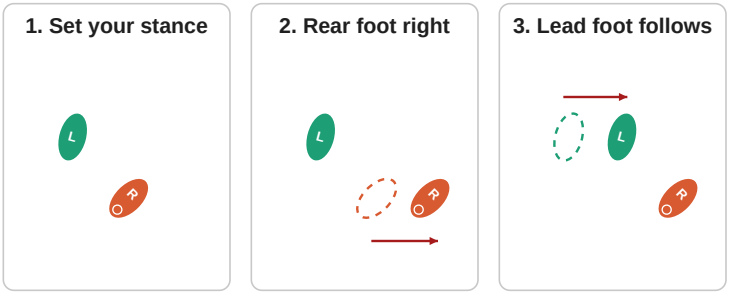
Footwork: Step left

See the footwork sheet for full cues.



Footwork: Step right

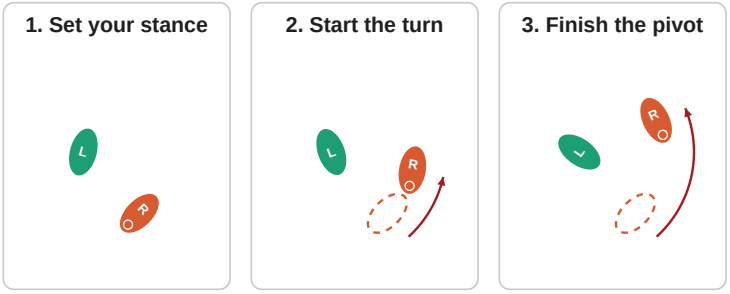
See the footwork sheet for full cues.



Footwork: Pivot

2 x 1 min

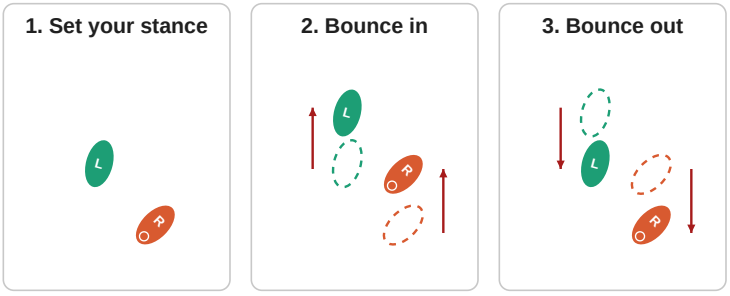
See the footwork sheet for full cues.



Footwork: In and out

3 x 30 sec

Both feet move together. Bounce in, bounce out.



Dark limbs = near side Light limbs = far side Dashed gray = previous position Red arrow = what moves

Technical shadowboxing

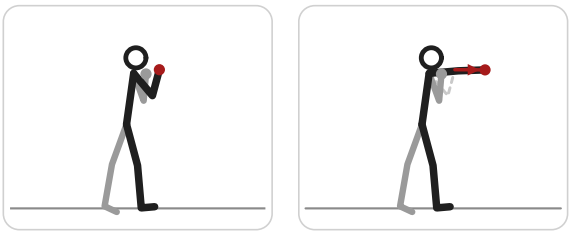
4 x 2 min, 1 min rest

Jab

R1: jab only (single, double, jab while stepping forward)

Side view

1. From guard, extend the lead hand straight out.
2. Turn the fist over at the end of the punch.
3. Snap it straight back to your face. Rear hand stays on your chin.

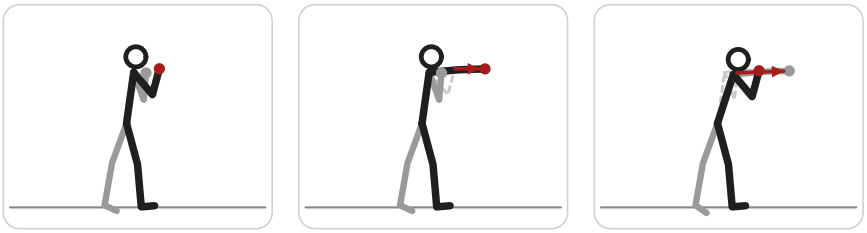


The 1-2

R2: cross, then the 1-2

Side view

1. Jab, bring it back, then cross.
2. Breathe out sharply on each punch.
3. Step in with the jab. Step out after the cross.

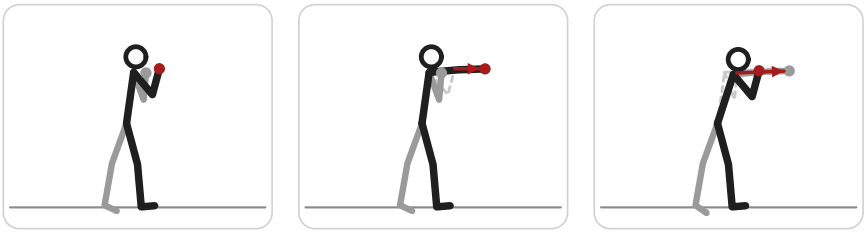


The 1-2

R3: 1-2, then step back out of range

Side view

1. Jab, bring it back, then cross.
2. Breathe out sharply on each punch.
3. Step in with the jab. Step out after the cross.

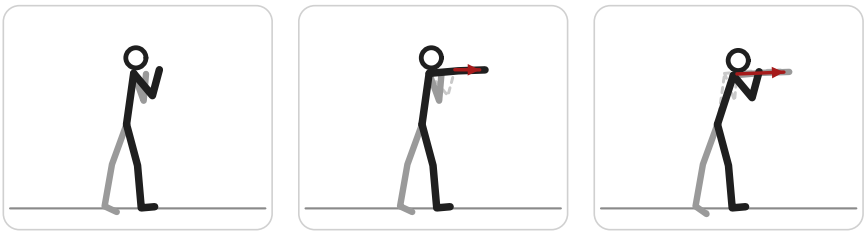


The 1-1-2

R4: freestyle 1, 2, and 1-1-2 with footwork

Side view

1. Double jab: the second jab comes from the same spot, don't pull all the way back.
2. Then the cross straight down the middle.
3. Back to guard every time.



Technical heavy bag

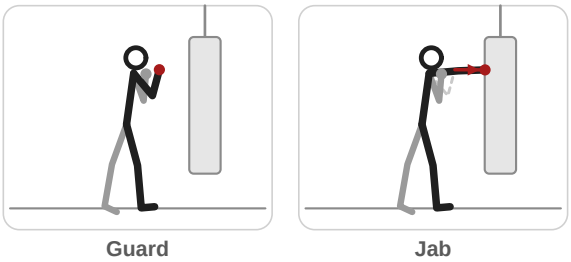
5 x 2 min, 1 min rest, 60% power

Jab

R1: jabs while circling the bag

Side view

1. From guard, extend the lead hand straight out.
2. Turn the fist over at the end of the punch.
3. Snap it straight back to your face. Rear hand stays on your chin.

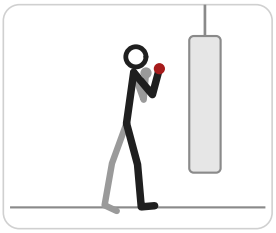


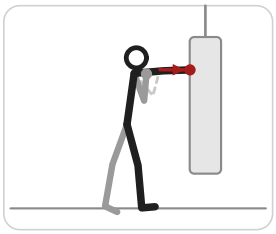
The 1-2

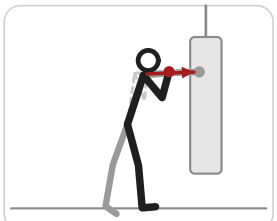
R2: 1-2

Side view

1. Jab, bring it back, then cross.
2. Breathe out sharply on each punch.
3. Step in with the jab. Step out after the cross.


Guard


1: Jab

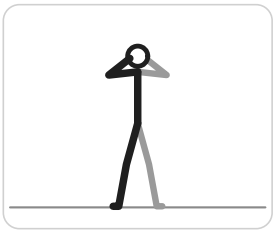

2: Cross

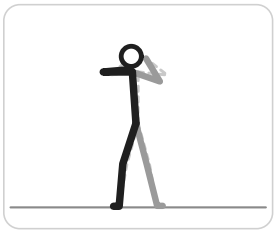
Lead hook

R3 introduces the hook. Learn the shape here first.

Front view

1. Elbow up to shoulder height, arm bent about 90 degrees.
2. Turn the lead hip and pivot on the ball of the lead foot. The punch comes from the turn.
3. Keep it short. Rear hand stays on your chin.


Guard

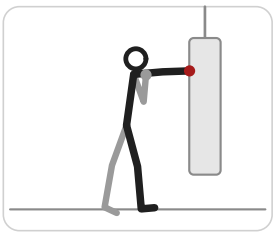

Hook

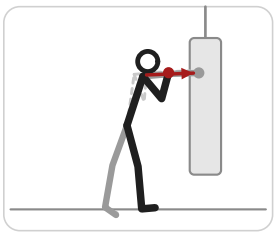
The 1-2-3

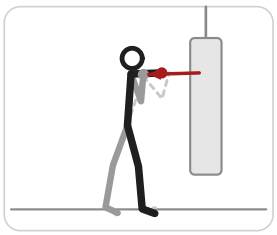
R3: 1-2-3

Side view

1. Jab, cross, lead hook.
2. The cross turns you one way, the hook turns you back.
3. Hands back to guard after the hook. Don't admire your work.


1: Jab


2: Cross

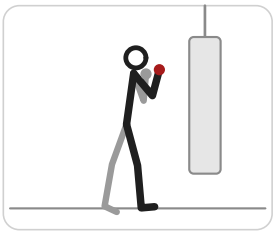

3: Hook

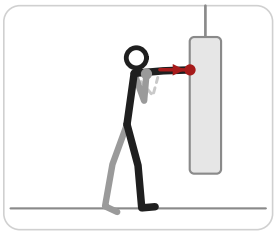
The 1-1-2

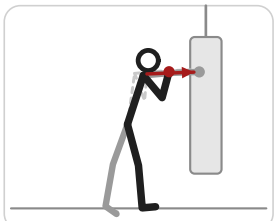
R4: 1-1-2

Side view

1. Double jab: the second jab comes from the same spot, don't pull all the way back.
2. Then the cross straight down the middle.
3. Back to guard every time.


Guard


1: Jab


2: Cross

- R5: freestyle, moving after every combo.

Speed bag intro

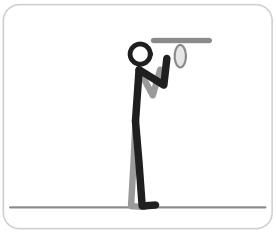
3 x 2 min, 1 min rest

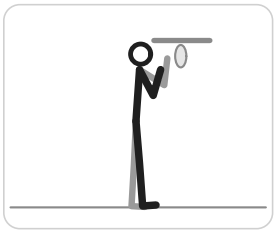
Speed bag

It'll look ugly for weeks. Everybody's does.

Side view

1. Fists at eye level, close to the bag.
2. Small circles with your fists, hitting in rhythm: rebound, rebound, hit.
3. Light touches. Rhythm over power.


Near fist


Far fist

Core

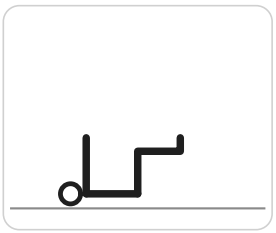
8 min, 30 sec rest between sets

Dead bug

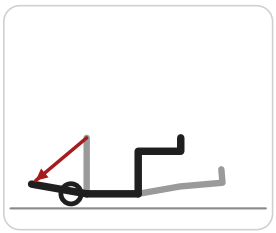
3 x 10 per side

Side view

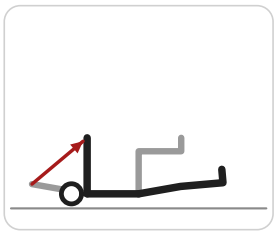
1. Lie on your back, arms up, knees over hips.
2. Press your low back into the floor. Keep it there.
3. Slowly extend the opposite arm and leg, return, switch sides.



Start



Opposite arm and leg



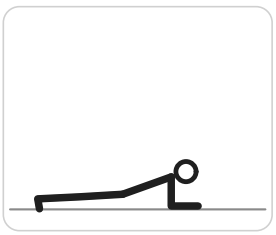
Switch sides

Plank

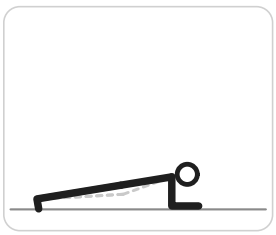
3 x 30 sec

Side view

1. Forearms on the floor, elbows under shoulders.
2. Squeeze your glutes and brace your stomach like you're about to take a punch.
3. One straight line from head to heels. Don't let the hips sag.



Wrong: hips sagging



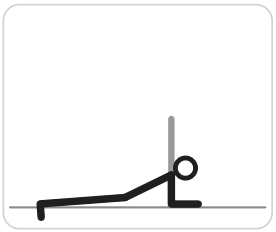
Right: straight line

Side plank

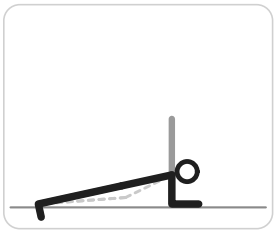
2 x 20 sec per side

Front view

1. Elbow directly under your shoulder, feet stacked.
2. Lift your hips until your body is one straight line.
3. Hold. Don't let your hips sag.



Set up



Lift and hold

Cool-down

8 min

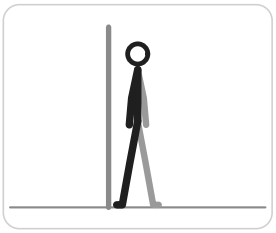
- 3 min easy walk.

Doorway chest stretch

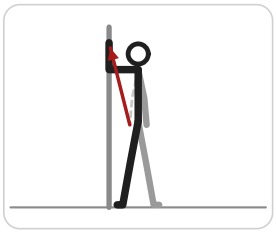
30-45 sec per side

Front view

1. Forearm on the door frame, elbow at shoulder height.
2. Step through the doorway until you feel it across your chest.
3. Keep your shoulder down. Breathe.



Stand



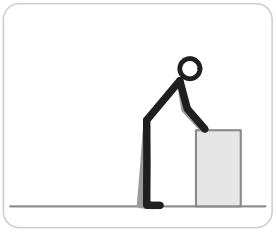
Forearm on frame

Lat stretch

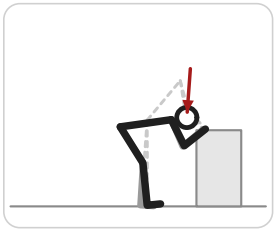
30-45 sec

Side view

1. Hands on a bench, counter, or rail about waist height.
2. Walk back and sit your hips back, arms straight.
3. Let your chest drop between your arms. Feel it along your sides.



Hands on rail



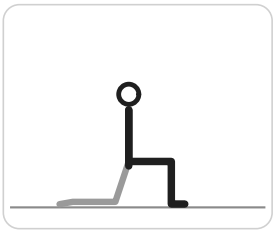
Sit back

Hip flexor stretch

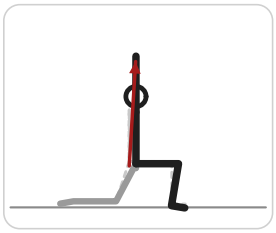
30–45 sec per side

Side view

1. Half-kneeling, front knee over the ankle.
2. Squeeze the glute of the down leg and shift your hips forward.
3. Reach the same-side arm up for more stretch.



Set up



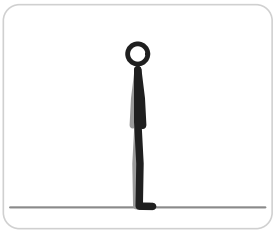
Hips forward, reach

Standing hamstring stretch

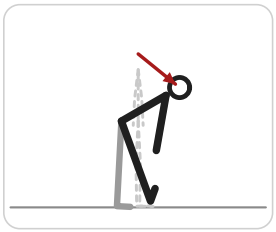
30–45 sec per side

Side view

1. Front heel down, toes up, leg straight.
2. Hinge at the hips with a flat back.
3. Stop when you feel it behind the thigh. No bouncing.



Stand tall



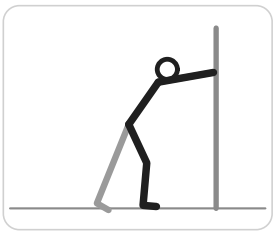
Hinge

Calf stretch

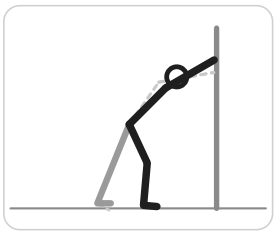
30–45 sec per side

Side view

1. Hands on the wall, back leg straight.
2. Press the back heel into the floor.
3. Lean in until you feel it in the calf.



Hands on wall



Heel down, lean in

- 1 min slow breathing: 4 counts in, 6 counts out.